

23/10/2025

Through thick and thin, When pigs fly, Let sleeping dogs lie, Your guess is as good as mine,
Back to square one

1 Through thick and thin (सुख-दुःख में) (Idiom) (thruo thik and thin) (Supportive / Loyal Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** To support or stay with someone through both good and bad times.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** सुख और दुःख दोनों में किसी का साथ देना या किसी स्थिति को झेलना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English → “**Thick**” (dense, difficult) + “**Thin**” (light, easy) → Combined metaphorically to mean enduring all conditions.
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** steadfastly, loyally, unwaveringly
 - **Antonym:** half-heartedly, inconsistently
- **Connotation:** Positive — symbolizes loyalty, endurance, and persistence.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Two friends trekking through a dense forest and an open field together, representing unwavering companionship.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In organizational culture, leaders who support their teams through thick and thin build trust and long-term loyalty. When challenges arise, standing beside colleagues instead of assigning blame fosters resilience. History has shown that societies progressing through thick and thin often develop stronger bonds and adaptive capacities, turning adversity into collective wisdom and strength.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *They remained friends through thick and thin.* (वे सुख-दुःख में सच्चे दोस्त बने रहे।)
-  *They remained through thick and thin friends.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Stand by your principles and people through thick and thin. Life's value shines in loyalty during adversity, not just comfort. Evaluate relationships and goals—are you consistent when things get tough? Cultivate steadiness, resilience, and genuine support; these are the true markers of trust and long-term character strength.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *She supported her family through thick and thin.* (उसने अपने परिवार का सुख-दुःख में साथ दिया।)
- **Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Transitive): supported
 - O (Object): her family
 - (Adverbial Phrase – Idiomatic): through thick and thin

- **Common Collocations:**

- stay through thick and thin, loyal through thick and thin, support through thick and thin

- **My Statement:**

- We earned his loyalty through thick and thin.
- He has always trusted his friend through thick and thin.
- We always admire those who remain with us through thick and thin.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

2 When pigs fly (कभी नहीं) (Idiom) (wen pigz flai) (Sarcastic / Humorous Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** Something that will never happen; an impossible event.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** ऐसा कुछ जो कभी नहीं होगा।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English humor → **absurd imagery** → “When pigs fly” = impossibility → **Modern idiom for disbelief.**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** never, not in a million years
 - **Antonym:** certainly, inevitably
- **Connotation:** Humorous or sarcastic — shows disbelief.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A man looking at the sky expecting a pig to fly with wings.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In strategic planning, dismissing innovation with a “when pigs fly” mindset restricts potential growth. Leaders must separate realistic skepticism from cynicism. While some ideas may seem impossible at first glance, history reminds us that many “flying pigs” have become real — from human flight to artificial intelligence breakthroughs.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *He'll apologize when pigs fly.* (वह तब माफ़ी माँगेगा जब सूअर उड़ेंगे — यानी कभी नहीं।)
-  *He'll apologize when pig will fly.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Don't wait for progress when pigs fly. Unrealistic expectations stall real growth. Replace impossible hopes with achievable actions. Instead of wishing for miracles, set measurable goals, act with consistency, and review outcomes. Progress isn't magic—it's momentum built through steady, practical effort that turns "never" into "now."

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *She'll stop shopping when pigs fly.* (वह खरीदारी तब बंद करेगी जब सूअर उड़ेंगे।)

- **Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure:**

- S (Subject): She
- V (Verb – Intransitive): will stop shopping
- O (Object): — (None; verb is intransitive)
- **(Adverbial Clause of Time – Idiomatic): when pigs fly**
- ↳ S: pigs
- ↳ V: fly

- **Common Collocations:**

- say when pigs fly, happen when pigs fly, believe when pigs fly

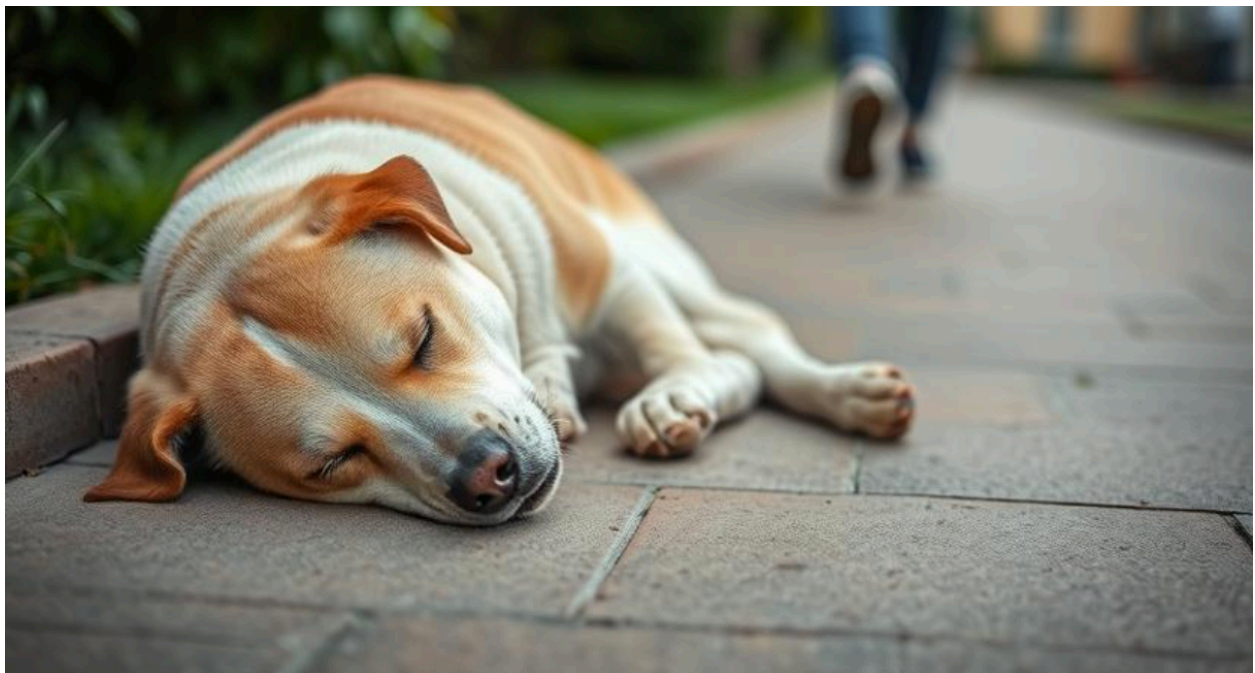
- **My Statement:**

- He will join us when pigs fly.
- She will accept his proposal when pigs fly.
- We will leave this place when pigs fly.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

3 Let sleeping dogs lie (पुरानी बातों को न छेड़ना) (Idiom) (let slee-ping dogz lai) (Cautious Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** Avoid interfering in a situation that's currently stable or resolved.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** पुरानी बातों को छेड़कर परेशानी न बढ़ाना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Medieval Proverb → “**It is nought good a slepyng hound to wake**” → Modern form “Let sleeping dogs lie.”
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** avoid trouble, stay out, move on
 - **Antonym:** stir things up, provoke
- **Connotation:** Neutral to positive — wisdom in restraint.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A calm dog sleeping peacefully — a person chooses to quietly walk away.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In conflict resolution, the principle of “let sleeping dogs lie” emphasizes strategic silence. Not every disagreement requires reopening old wounds. Skilled negotiators know when peace outweighs confrontation. By letting dormant issues rest, relationships can heal

and mature without unnecessary friction, strengthening mutual respect and long-term understanding.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *It's better to let sleeping dogs lie.* (बेहतर है कि पुरानी बातों को न छेड़ा जाए।)
-  *It's better to lie sleeping dogs let.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Learn to let sleeping dogs lie in conflicts and past mistakes. Not every issue needs reopening. Preserve energy and relationships by knowing when to stay silent. Strategic restraint often prevents unnecessary trouble, fosters peace, and allows focus on growth. Wisdom lies in choosing your battles carefully.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *He didn't bring up the past; he let sleeping dogs lie.* (उसने पुरानी बातें नहीं छेड़ीं; उसने उन्हें वहीं छोड़ दिया।)

- **Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure:**

- **Sentence 1: He didn't bring up the past.**
- S (Subject): He
- V (Verb – Phrasal, Transitive): didn't bring up
- O (Object): the past
- **Sentence 2: He let sleeping dogs lie.**
- S (Subject): He
- V (Verb – Causative, Transitive): let
- O (Object Phrase – Idiom): sleeping dogs lie

- **Common Collocations:**

- let sleeping dogs lie, prefer to let sleeping dogs lie, wisely let sleeping dogs lie

- **My Statement:**

- He didn't provoke his brother; he let sleeping dogs lie.
- It's always better to let sleeping dogs lie.
- You could bring trouble upon yourself if you don't let sleeping dogs lie.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

4 Your guess is as good as mine (मुझे भी नहीं पता) (Idiom) (yor ges iz az gud az main) (Neutral / Honest Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** I don't know either; both of us are equally uncertain.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** मुझे भी उतना ही पता है जितना तुम्हें।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - 19th-century English → **Common expression of equal uncertainty** → Modern idiomatic use for honesty or humility.
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** I have no idea, who knows
 - **Antonym:** I'm certain, I know for sure
- **Connotation:** Neutral — conveys honesty and shared uncertainty.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Two people shrugging together, both unsure of the answer.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

When dealing with emerging technologies, analysts often admit — “your guess is as good as mine.” This honesty allows collaborative exploration instead of false confidence. In decision-making, acknowledging uncertainty can open the door to learning, joint discovery, and adaptive strategies rather than rigid, uninformed conclusions.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *When will the rain stop? — Your guess is as good as mine. (बारिश कब रुकेगी? — मुझे भी नहीं पता।)*
-  *Your guess is good as mine.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Admit uncertainty with your guess is as good as mine. Embracing what you don't know fosters humility, honesty, and open-minded collaboration. Instead of pretending, share ideas, ask questions, and explore together. Acknowledging limits of knowledge creates trust, sparks learning, and often leads to better solutions than false confidence ever could.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *When will the meeting start? Your guess is as good as mine. (मीटिंग कब शुरू होगी? मुझे भी नहीं पता।)*

- **Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure:**

- **Sentence 1: When will the meeting start?**
- S (Subject): the meeting
- V (Verb – Intransitive): will start
- O (Object): — (None; verb is intransitive)
- (Adverbial Clause of Time): When
- **Sentence 2: Your guess is as good as mine.**
- S (Subject): Your guess
- V (Verb – Linking): is
- **C (Complement – Comparative Phrase): as good as mine**
- ↳ Pronoun (Possessive within Complement): mine

- **Common Collocations:**

- say your guess is as good as mine, reply your guess is as good as mine, shrug and say your guess is as good as mine

- **My Statement:**

- When will the show start? Your guess is as good as mine.
- What is the correct option for this question? Your guess is as good as mine.
- What is her age? Your guess is as good as mine.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

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- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**



Entrepreneurial ventures often go back to square one after early setbacks. This phrase symbolizes resilience — the willingness to reassess and rebuild. Great innovators rarely succeed without failure; they restart with refined insights. In life and business, going back to square one isn't defeat — it's strategic renewal.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *After the system crash, we were back to square one.* (सिस्टम क्रैश होने के बाद हमें फिर से शुरुआत करनी पड़ी।)
-  *After the crash, we went to square first.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Embrace setbacks with back to square one as an opportunity, not failure. Every restart carries lessons from past attempts. Analyze, adjust, and approach tasks with renewed strategy. Resilience grows when you treat beginnings as chances to improve, transforming previous mistakes into a stronger foundation for success.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *After months of failed experiments, we were back to square one.* (कई महीनों की असफल कोशिशों के बाद हमें फिर से शुरुआत करनी पड़ी।)

- **Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure:**

- S (Subject): we
- V (Verb – Linking + Complement): were back to square one
- O (Object): — (None; idiomatic expression acts as complement)
- **(Adverbial Clause of Time): After months of failed experiments**
 - ↳ Noun Phrase: months
 - ↳ Prepositional Phrase (of Description): of failed experiments

- **Common Collocations:**

- go back to square one, start back at square one, end up back to square one

- **My Statement:**

- After losing a match by a large margin, we have to get back to square one for training.
- After months of uncertainty, we're heading back to square one.
- He will end up back at square one.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]